The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia
Gulf Waters

Issued at 9:30 am CDT on Sunday 18 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Tuesday 20 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A slow-moving high pressure system over the Tasman Sea extends a ridge over eastern SA. A trough of low pressure over WA is expected to move into western SA later today and over southeastern parts later Monday, while a weakening cold front crosses the Bight. The trough lingers in the east through the middle of the week as a weak high pressure system forms in the Bight.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots near the Yorke Peninsula coast early in the morning. Winds shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo during the evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northeast to southeasterly in the middle of the day then tending northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots becoming variable below 10 knots in the evening then becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late afternoon and evening.

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Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Central Coast

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly before dawn then shifting south to southwesterly in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning easterly in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots through the Backstairs Passage early in the morning. Winds tending northerly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre during the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:30 pm CDT Sunday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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